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For India to achieve developed nation status by 2047, our states must grow. What is your road map for Goa's economy?

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has laid out the Viksit Bharat 2047 vision, and we have started work on our vision document, called Goa 2037. At present, Goa has the highest per capita income in the country, at around ₹5.6 lakh. Our economy primarily draws from four key sectors—mining, tourism, services, and industrial manufacturing. Each of these is being revitalised in a structured, sustainable manner.

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Are you expecting a return of the mining boom the state saw 10–15 years ago? And if so, how would you take care of environmental concerns?

I would not call it a boom in the old sense, but yes, I will emphasise sustainable mining. As mining leases are revived, people who were dependent on mining—truck drivers, local workers, equipment operators—are getting jobs again. In the next two years, a 100% revival will happen. We have also started auctioning dumps—previously rejected ore lying around. The Supreme Court has allowed us to

employment will increase, and economic revival will be widespread in rural areas. We are focusing on sustainable mining—reviving both operational blocks and dumped ore via auctions, while protecting the environment.

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How many mining blocks will be operational within two years, and what kind of revenue are you expecting?

All 12 auctioned blocks will be operational by then, and we plan to auction at least four more. At present, we are generating ₹500–700 crore in direct revenue. Once full operations begin, we expect to

Goa has always been synonymous with sun, sand, and sea, but that is changing. Today, we are diversifying our tourism offering to include spiritual tourism, hinterland and eco-tourism, wellness and ayurveda tourism, medical tourism, and even sports tourism. We have introduced progressive policies to support this shift, such as our Caravan Policy, Bed and Breakfast Policy, and Homestay Policy. We are also offering tax holidays for investors ready to spend ₹500 crore or more in non-coastal regions. This strategy is already redirecting tourism flows inward, away from the beaches and into our rich rural and cultural interiors.

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Our reforms in the wellness sector are significant, and yes, we intend to compete with Kerala in attracting global wellness and medical tourists

Mining, for instance, had come to a halt following a Supreme Court judgment in 2012, but we have now successfully revived the sector. We have auctioned 12 mining blocks so far. This revival is enabling export of low-grade iron ore to countries like China and Australia and has already begun to generate significant economic activity within the state.

export 20 million tonnes annually. We will achieve this maximum limit. Out of 12 talukas, eight were heavily mining-dependent. The mining revival will positively impact agriculture as well. For instance, farmers used to receive compensation earlier, but that stopped when mining was halted. Now that mining is back, the compensation will resume, rural

cross the ₹1,000 crore mark annually. And that is just the direct impact. Indirect economic benefits from employment and support services will be even more substantial.

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The sector most closely associated with Goa is tourism. How will it shape up over the next 20 years?

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As an ayurvedic health practitioner yourself, do you see Goa competing with Kerala as a health and wellness tourism destination?

Definitely. Goa has a natural advantage with its lush green environment; 70% of the state is under green cover. We have established a top-tier Ayush hospital near Mopa Airport that offers postgraduate education in Ayurveda and attracts students from both India and abroad. In addition, we have Ayurvedic, Unani, and Homeopathy colleges, as well as a new Naturopathy and Yogic Sciences college. Wellness clinics have been launched across all government